

BIG LAUNCHES THIS MONTH

APRIL HAS SEEN A LINE OF NEW CARS BEING LAUNCHED — WITH EACH BEING DIFFERENT FROM THE OTHER.

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MAINSTREAM LUXURY: 2018 BMW X3

BMW India withdrew the older X3 last year in anticipation of the new generation's arrival in India, and now, it's finally here. The third generation, 2018 BMW X3 SUV has been launched in India today with two variants, and is priced at ₹49.9 lac and ₹56.7 lac, respectively.

So, what has changed? Quite a fair bit, to be honest. The X3 does not look burly any longer — instead, it has this sense of flowing elegance that you would seldom see in SUVs. The new BMW X3 is based on an all-new platform that makes the car lighter, and along with the lesser body weight, BMW has added a few more horsepower to it. As a result, the new X3 is still powered by the trusted 2-litre, 4-cylinder twin-turbocharged diesel workhorse, but now produces 190bhp and 400Nm torque. BMW has unveiled the X3 only with the standard Diesel engine, and the petrol engine will follow soon.

Cosmetic changes are not major, except for smoother flowing design lines now in place of the sharper edges. Even the chrome-laden butterfly grille look different from before, although it does look a bit timid and car-like than before. On the inside, the new generation BMW X3 delivers a few more changes than on the outside. For starters, you get the new generation almost-digital instrument cluster, which replaces the traditional speedometer and tachometer for blank, dark digital panels.



The infotainment system gets an upgrade, and is based on the iDrive firmware that also powers the 5-Series and 7-Series cars. The screen is bigger now, at 12.3 inches, and is a fully touch-operated unit that retains the iDrive controller. The circular main menu design is now replaced by the horizontal column-like tiles, but hope as we may, the X3 does not get gesture controls. It also gets parking assist, although the monochrome Head-Up Display (HUD) has not been continued here. Other features include High Beam Assist, a larger panoramic glass roof, six-colour ambient lighting system with footwell illumination

and exterior welcome light, the BMW Display Key, 9° reclining rear seats, wireless charging and a 600W, 16-speaker Harman/Kardon surround audio system.

Much about the BMW X3's original essence remains the same. It looks and feels agile, which fits with its positioning as a mid-size sports activity vehicle. It also retains the 550-litre boot space, and gets a space saver tyre strapped in underneath the rug of the boot. The dashboard, as always, remains almost exactly the same. The driver-oriented design gets a two-tone leather upholstery, and the buttons now get a faux-metal finish. But the overall